TOUCHED BY THE SIGNAL

Incursion-Touched Items | DM Handout, Class of 2005

WHAT THESE ARE

The incursion is soaking mundane things with whatever the salt bed is broadcasting. Most of Hutchinson will never notice. A few objects, the ones people used the most and loved the most, begin to work as **magic items**. They are the only magic items in the campaign. Nobody can buy them, and there are no magic armor shops in Kansas.

How they work. Each item keeps looking exactly like its mundane self and shows a small **tell** to anyone who looks closely. Anyone can use an item. Items marked **Attunement** take a short rest to bond. Rarities follow the 2024 Dungeon Master's Guide: +1 uncommon, +2 rare.

Games. Only **sports and game equipment** also gives **advantage on every check you make while playing that game**: the bat in baseball, the club in golf, the cue in pool, the helmet in football, the cards in a card game and the skateboard in a trick contest. The bonus covers real games with rules, scoring and other players, and it applies to friendly games only. It does not apply in a real fight, and other items do not get one.

Awakening still matters. A character who has not awakened still uses these items. They are what a mundane student has until their class wakes up. Hand them out as treasure, loot, or something a character already owned. Give one to an NPC with no explanation.

WEAPONS

Item	What it does	Tell and games
1. Aluminum Baseball Bat *Rare, requires attunement*	Functions as a **+2 shortsword** (1d6 + 2 bludgeoning, finesse, light). Once per session, a hit sends the target 10 ft away (Strength save DC 14 negates).	**Games:** Baseball and softball: advantage on every check and attack roll. **Tell:** *Rings like a bell when swung and smells faintly of salt.*
2. Pool Cue *Uncommon*	Functions as a **+1 quarterstaff** (1d6 + 1 bludgeoning, versatile 1d8 + 1). *Called shot:* once per session, a ball, coin or key you flick with it hits any target you can see within 60 ft, ignoring cover, for 1d6 + 1 bludgeoning.	**Games:** Pool and billiards: advantage on every check. **Tell:** *The chalk never wears down, and the cue ball always rolls back.*
3. Seven Iron *Uncommon*	Functions as a **+1 mace** (1d6 + 1 bludgeoning). On a critical hit the target is knocked 15 ft and falls prone (Strength save DC 13 negates).	**Games:** Golf and mini golf: advantage on every check. **Tell:** *The grip is always warm, even in winter.*
4. Tire Iron *Uncommon*	Functions as a **+1 club** (1d4 + 1 bludgeoning) and as thieves' tools for forcing locks, hoods, doors and lockers. Advantage on checks to pry something open.	**Tell:** *Never rusts, and it is always cold to the touch.*
5. Bike Lock Chain *Uncommon*	Functions as a **+1 whip** (1d4 + 1 bludgeoning, finesse, reach 10 ft). Once per session, a hit wraps the target: Dexterity save DC 13 or restrained until the end of its next turn.	**Tell:** *The links clink in time with your footsteps.*
6. Wrist-Rocket Slingshot *Uncommon*	Functions as a **+1 sling** (range 60/240 ft, 1d4 + 1 bludgeoning). It never runs out of ammunition: it fires pebbles from your pocket. A natural 20 deafens the target until the end of its next turn.	**Tell:** *Any pebble you pick up is smooth and round.*
7. Rubber Prop Dagger *Uncommon*	Functions as a **+1 dagger** (1d4 + 1 piercing, finesse, light, thrown 20/60). Everyone but you sees only a rubber prop (Insight DC 15 sees the truth). Advantage on Deception to pass it off as a prop.	**Tell:** *The edge is cold and never leaves a mark on cloth.*

ARMOR AND WORN ITEMS

Item	What it does	Tell and games
8. Letterman Jacket *Rare, requires attunement*	Functions as **+1 leather armor** (AC 12 + Dexterity + 1) and gives you resistance to cold damage. Wearing it does not give disadvantage on Stealth.	**Tell:** *Your name is stitched on the back even if you never had it embroidered.*
9. Football Helmet *Uncommon*	While worn, you have advantage on Constitution saves to stay conscious, and once per session a critical hit against you becomes a normal hit.	**Games:** Football: advantage on every check and attack roll. **Tell:** *Your voice sounds like a roaring crowd inside it.*
10. Welding Mask *Uncommon*	While worn, you cannot be blinded by bright light or flashes, you have advantage on saves against gaze effects, and you see in dim light as if it were bright light out to 30 ft.	**Tell:** *Everything looks faintly green through the glass.*
11. Steel-Toe Boots *Uncommon*	Your kicks are **+1 unarmed strikes** (1d6 + 1 bludgeoning). You ignore difficult terrain made of mud, ice, snow or salt.	**Tell:** *The laces tie themselves when you are not looking.*
12. Class Ring of 2005 *Rare, requires attunement*	Functions as a **ring of protection**: +1 to AC and to all saving throws. Once per session, spend your reaction to turn a hit against you into a miss.	**Tell:** *The stone shows a tiny skyline of Hutchinson at night.*

WONDROUS ITEMS

Item	What it does	Tell and games
13. TI-83 Calculator *Rare*	Once per session, ask the DM a question about a number, code, pattern or count. The answer is always true (how many, which door, what the cipher says). It also solves any cipher if you give it a minute.	**Tell:** *The screen sometimes shows a number you never typed.*
14. Discman *Uncommon*	While a disc plays, you and allies within 10 ft have advantage on saves against fear and charm. As an action, throw the disc (range 30/60 ft, 1d6 slashing); it spins back to your hand.	**Tell:** *It plays the song you need, not the one in the tray.*
15. Zippo Lighter *Uncommon*	It never goes out, even in rain or underwater. As a bonus action, wreathe a weapon in flame for 1 minute (+1d4 fire damage on hits). Once per session. The flame sheds light in 20 ft.	**Tell:** *The flame is the wrong color, a pale blue-white.*

WONDROUS ITEMS (CONTINUED)

Item	What it does	Tell and games
16. Deck of Cards *Rare, requires attunement*	You always know the top card. Once per session, draw a card: the DM gives you a small boon or one true fact. Advantage on Sleight of Hand with cards.	**Games:** Every card game: advantage on every check. **Tell:** *The face cards seem to watch the table.*
17. Walkie-Talkies (pair) *Uncommon*	Talk to the other unit at any distance, even through walls and underground. After each use, make a DC 12 Wisdom save or hear a strange voice on the line and have disadvantage on your next check.	**Tell:** *The static almost sounds like words.*
18. Skateboard *Uncommon*	While standing on it, your speed rises by 10 ft and you ignore difficult terrain on paved ground. Once per session, leap 20 ft and land without taking damage.	**Games:** Skateboarding tricks and contests: advantage on every check. **Tell:** *It rolls a little by itself when nobody is looking.*
19. Flashlight *Uncommon*	The beam reveals invisible creatures, hidden doors and the faint glow of the signal. Creatures lit by it have disadvantage on Stealth checks. Bright light 60 ft cone, dim light another 60 ft.	**Tell:** *The batteries have never died, and they are not the kind you bought.*
20. Magic 8 Ball *Rare, requires attunement*	Once per session, shake it and ask a yes or no question. The DM answers truthfully through one of the twenty answers. You cannot ask the same question twice.	**Tell:** *The answer in the window never changes until you have earned a new one.*

RUNNING THEM

- **Foreshadow, then reveal.** The first time an item does something impossible, make it a small moment: a ball curves, a flame turns blue. Let the player work out why before you tell them.
- **Escalate.** The longer a character carries an item, the stronger the tell becomes. Strong tells draw attention from the people who are collecting these things.
- **Make it cost something.** Use the Walkie-Talkies' voice, the Deck's cards and the 8 Ball's answers to push the mystery. Any item can be taken, traded or stolen.
- **Add your own.** Anything a student carries every day is a candidate: a trapper keeper, a retainer case, a lunchbox, a varsity pin. Pick a weapon, a protection or a trick, add a game, and pick a tell.